



Mumbai 1997: Australia - 412/3; Denmark - 49 | Aus won by 363 runs

Australia's dominance in the sphere of women's cricket has long been established, but few results prove that like its 363-run drubbing of Denmark during the 1997 World Cup in Mumbai. On a day when seemingly everything went the Aussies' way, they won the toss and opted to bat first, scoring a mammoth 412/3. Captain Belinda Clark was the star of the show, showing no mercy to the Danish bowlers as she played an unbeaten 229, ably supported by fifties from Lisa Keightley and Karen Rolton.

The Aussie bowlers then gave the Danes no respite, with Cathryn Fitzpatrick and Charmaine Mason striking early before Rolton returned to remove the tail as Denmark was rolled over for a mere 49. Among the records to tumble under the scorching Mumbai sun were the highest team score in a World Cup, highest individual score in a World Cup, and the largest margin of victory (in runs) in a World Cup, all of which stand to this day.

Lincoln 2000: New Zealand - 184; Australia - 180 | NZ won by four runs

New Zealand is the only team other than England and Australia to have won a World Cup, and it took a nail-biting final against trans-Tasman rivals Australia to do so.

The hosts went into the 2000 final as underdogs against an Australian side that had won all seven of its matches in the tournament up to that point, and when New Zealand was bowled out for 184, only one result seemed likely.

Cathryn Fitzpatrick took three wickets for the Aussies and no New Zealand batter was able to cross the half-century mark, with Kathryn Ramel top-scoring with 41.

New Zealand struck early with the ball to remove the prolific Lisa Keightley and Karen Rolton, but captain Belinda Clark's 91 meant that Australia was still well-placed to take home a second consecutive trophy. New Zealand, however, hung on, chipping away with regular wickets, and forced the match into the final over, where Australia required five runs with one wicket in hand. On

In vain: Australia won comfortably despite a whirlwind unbeaten 178 by Chamari Athapaththu. **Facing page:** Charmaine Mason looks on as New Zealand players celebrate her wicket and its first World Cup title.

came off-spinner Claire Nicholson, who found Charmaine Mason's outside edge to seal a four-run victory and New Zealand's first World Cup title, on home soil no less.

Pretoria 2005: South Africa - 169; West Indies - 168 | SA won by one run

Both South Africa and West Indies came into this fixture looking for their first win of the tournament after their campaign openers didn't yield a result.

Winning the toss, host South Africa's openers Daleen Terblanche and Cri-zelda Brits came out to bat at the Laudium Oval in Pretoria. But Terblanche's walk back to the dugout came soon enough after she holed out to Shane de Silva off Debbie-Ann Lewis. The Proteas lost quick wickets — languishing at 61/5 in 7.4 overs —